

Spreadsheet Basics

Learning Objectives

- Understand the structure of rows, columns, and cells
- Enter and format data in a spreadsheet
- Use basic formulas for calculations

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a shopkeeper's ledger—a big book with rows and columns tracking items sold and money earned. A spreadsheet is a digital ledger that can calculate totals automatically. Today we learn this powerful tool for working with numbers.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open the spreadsheet. Note the grid of rows (numbered) and columns (lettered). Click on different cells and see their addresses like A1, B2. Enter numbers in several cells. Try the SUM formula to add a column of numbers. Format cells with borders and colors.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Spreadsheets organize data in a grid of cells. Each cell has an address based on its column letter and row number. You enter text or numbers in cells and use formulas starting with “=” for calculations. SUM adds numbers, AVERAGE finds the mean, and COUNT tallies items. Formulas update automatically when data changes.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a monthly expense tracker. List items in column A and prices in column B. Use SUM to calculate the total. Add a column for quantities and calculate cost as price times quantity. Like a farmer tracking crop yields, your spreadsheet organizes and calculates data automatically.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: What is the address of the cell in column C and row 5? Write a formula to add cells A1 through A5. How is a spreadsheet different from a regular table on paper? Name one advantage of using formulas.